

The Agent Gap: can an AI buying agent find, price and reach B2B software? 70 vendors, 3 tasks, one agent, October 2026

Broadcastwell. Measured 6 October 2026 UTC. Final study; complete primary and repeat evidence. Generated 2026-10-06T20:47:58.783424+00:00. Incremental study spend: \$0 on the existing signed-in seat; this does not claim the underlying subscription is free.

Abstract

We tested 70 selected B2B software vendors across 14 categories with ChatGPT Work with Cloud browser. The displayed product and mode are preserved in each receipt. Each vendor received three fixed tasks in a fresh conversation: describe the vendor, read its pricing page, and reach its empty demo or sales form. All 210 of 210 primary sessions were captured. Of 209 scored sessions, 159 passed and 50 failed. The pass rate was 76.1% (95 percent Wilson interval 69.9% to 81.4%). One of 210 primary sessions, Pipedrive S2, has unknown currency evidence and is unscored. Unknown is neither a pass nor a failure.

Found was yes for 210 of 210 sessions across 70 vendors. Pricing-task facts were correct in 67 of 69 evaluable S2 answers; this includes accurate no-public-price and access-limitation reports, not only numerical prices. Pricing destinations were reached in 52 of 70 S2 sessions. Demo or sales forms were reached in 44 of 70 S3 sessions. The required destination was not reached in 47 of 210 primary sessions.

The preselected repeat sample contains ten vendors and 30 task pairs. 30 of 30 repeats are captured, with 28 scored and 2 unknown. Complete Found, Correct and Reached triplets agree in 27 of 28 evaluable pairs among 30 captured pairs. 2 captured pairs include an unknown score and cannot establish complete-triplet agreement.

Selection and method

The frozen set contains the five most-named vendors in each category of Absence Index release 2026-09, DOI 10.5281/zenodo.22907695. Ties use vendor-domain cited count, then alphabetical order. The ten repeat vendors were selected before the first run by sorting category and vendor and taking positions 0, 7, 14, 21, 28, 35, 42, 49, 56 and 63. No vendor, task or scoring rule was substituted after observing results. The owner amended the study to one agent on 6 October; the original protocol, amendment and excluded evidence are retained separately.

The study is single-agent and single-run: one primary run per vendor and task. Repeat runs measure agreement separately; they do not replace, average or repair primary results. Every repeat began at least two hours after its corresponding primary observed end. Observed end times are upper bounds where collection occurred after completion; the product's displayed duration is retained in the receipts. The same exact filled prompt was reused for each repeat.

Perplexity Computer ran five sessions on two vendors before its seat showed no credits; they are not part of the study figures. The preserved receipts identify Procore (three sessions) and Buildertrend (two). They are excluded from every primary, repeat, category, pass-rate and agreement denominator.

ChatGPT sometimes used public content retrieval or web search instead of its Cloud browser. Receipts distinguish those operations from a rendered browser visit. A content fetch is not called a browser rendering. Results describe this product, mode, prompt set and day, not every future run.

Tasks and scoring

Each prompt began with: Do not type into or submit any form on any vendor site. Do not enter personal details, create an account, buy anything, accept terms, send a message, sign in, solve a challenge or request payment. When a demo or contact form loads, stop with all fields empty. Browse only public pages. Report the exact URLs and any block you actually encounter.

- S1: Find the vendor <Vendor> (<domain>). From its own site, tell me what it is, who it is for and what it costs. Give the URLs you read.
- S2: Open the pricing page on <domain> and list the plans and prices shown. Tell me the URL and whether anything stopped you from reading it.
- S3: Get me to the page on <domain> where I can request a demo or contact sales. Open the form and stop. Do not fill in or submit anything. Tell me the URL and what the form asks for.

The original score definitions, verbatim: Found: the agent identified <Vendor> as the vendor in question. Correct: the agent stated no false fact about <Vendor> when checked against <Vendor>'s own site read the same day. Reached: the page the task needed loaded for the agent with no block, challenge page or empty render. Position: where <Vendor> stood in any shortlist or comparison the agent produced.

The study's fixed single-run adaptation passes a session only when Found, Correct and Reached are all yes. Source checks use the same UTC day. Position is recorded separately and is not a ranking score. A correct statement that no public price is displayed can pass. Unknown evidence remains unscored. The commercial Agent Test's two-run rule is not used to aggregate this study.

Results by task

Task	Pass / scored base	Pass rate	95 percent Wilson interval	Unknown / captured base
S1: Describe	66 / 70	94.3%	86.2% to 97.8%	0 / 70
S2: Pricing page	49 / 69	71.0%	59.4% to 80.4%	1 / 70
S3: Demo path	44 / 70	62.9%	51.1% to 73.2%	0 / 70
Overall: All tasks	159 / 209	76.1%	69.9% to 81.4%	1 / 210

Wilson intervals quantify binomial uncertainty for the observed scored sessions. They do not turn the purposively selected set into a random sample of the software market. Tasks share vendors, and outputs

share one agent and one day; the pooled interval does not account for that dependence. Unknown evidence is excluded from the scored denominator and explicitly reported in the captured denominator.

Results across 14 categories

Category	Vendors / selected	Pass / scored base	Unknown / captured base	95 percent Wilson interval
construction project management	5 / 5	15 / 15	0 / 15	79.6% to 100.0%
dealership management systems	5 / 5	10 / 15	0 / 15	41.7% to 84.8%
dental practice management	5 / 5	11 / 15	0 / 15	48.0% to 89.1%
field service management	5 / 5	13 / 15	0 / 15	62.1% to 96.3%
hotel property management	5 / 5	14 / 15	0 / 15	70.2% to 98.8%
insurance agency management	5 / 5	10 / 15	0 / 15	41.7% to 84.8%
legal practice management	5 / 5	13 / 15	0 / 15	62.1% to 96.3%
loan origination software	5 / 5	6 / 15	0 / 15	19.8% to 64.3%
radiology medical imaging	5 / 5	11 / 15	0 / 15	48.0% to 89.1%
residential property management	5 / 5	10 / 15	0 / 15	41.7% to 84.8%
transportation management systems	5 / 5	11 / 15	0 / 15	48.0% to 89.1%
veterinary practice management	5 / 5	12 / 15	0 / 15	54.8% to 93.0%
crm	5 / 5	12 / 14	1 / 15	60.1% to 96.0%
project management	5 / 5	11 / 15	0 / 15	48.0% to 89.1%

Vendor results

Each cell is the single ChatGPT Work primary result. Pass requires Found, Correct and Reached. Fail means at least one is no. Unknown is unscored. Every category contains five selected vendors.

construction project management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Buildertrend	pass	pass	pass
Contractor Foreman	pass	pass	pass
Fieldwire	pass	pass	pass
JobTread	pass	pass	pass
Procore	pass	pass	pass

dealership management systems

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
CDK Global	pass	fail	pass
DealerCenter	pass	pass	pass
Dealertrack	fail	fail	fail
Frazer	pass	pass	pass
Tekion	pass	fail	pass

dental practice management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Curve Dental	pass	pass	pass
Dentrix	pass	pass	pass
Dentrix Ascend	pass	fail	pass
Eaglesoft	pass	fail	fail
Open Dental	pass	pass	fail

field service management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
FieldPulse	pass	pass	fail
Housecall Pro	pass	pass	pass
Jobber	pass	pass	fail
ServiceTitan	pass	pass	pass
Workiz	pass	pass	pass

hotel property management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Cloudbeds	pass	pass	pass
Little Hotelier	pass	pass	pass
Maestro PMS	pass	fail	pass
Mews	pass	pass	pass
Stayntouch	pass	pass	pass

insurance agency management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Applied Systems	pass	fail	pass
EZLynx	pass	pass	fail
HawkSoft	pass	pass	pass
NowCerts	fail	fail	pass
Vertafore	pass	fail	pass

legal practice management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
8am MyCase	pass	pass	pass
Clio	pass	pass	fail
CosmoLex	pass	pass	pass
Filevine	pass	pass	pass
PracticePanther	pass	pass	fail

loan origination software

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Abrigo	pass	fail	fail
Baker Hill	pass	fail	fail
ICE Mortgage Technology	pass	fail	pass
MeridianLink	pass	fail	fail
nCino	fail	fail	pass

radiology medical imaging

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Fujifilm (Synapse)	pass	fail	fail
Intelerad	pass	fail	pass
RamSoft	pass	pass	pass
Sectra	pass	pass	pass
Visage Imaging	pass	fail	pass

residential property management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
AppFolio	fail	fail	pass
Buildium	pass	pass	fail
DoorLoop	pass	pass	pass
Innago	pass	pass	fail
Yardi	pass	pass	fail

transportation management systems

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Alvys	pass	pass	fail
AscendTMS	pass	fail	pass
Oracle Transportation Management	pass	pass	fail
SAP Transportation Management	pass	pass	fail
Tai TMS	pass	pass	pass

veterinary practice management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
DaySmart Vet	pass	pass	fail
Digitail	pass	pass	pass
ezyVet	pass	pass	fail
IDEXX (Cornerstone, Neo)	pass	pass	pass
Shepherd	pass	fail	pass

crm

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
HubSpot CRM	pass	pass	pass
Microsoft Dynamics 365	pass	pass	pass
Pipedrive	pass	unknown	fail
Salesforce Sales Cloud	pass	pass	pass
Zoho CRM	pass	pass	fail

project management

Vendor	S1: Describe	S2: Pricing	S3: Demo path
Asana	pass	pass	fail
ClickUp	pass	pass	fail
Jira	pass	pass	fail
Smartsheet	pass	pass	fail
Wrike	pass	pass	pass

Obstacles and factual checks

Terminal groups are mutually exclusive: a confirmed empty destination takes precedence over a later timeout. Other includes missing destinations, HTTP refusals and tool failures.

Terminal obstacle group	Sessions / primary base
edge challenge	0 / 210
login wall	0 / 210
empty render	6 / 210
timeout	19 / 210
other	22 / 210

The required destination was not reached in 47 of 210 primary sessions. Reasons below are the recorded terminal obstacles; a 403 alone does not establish an edge challenge or a login wall. Recovered errors remain in receipts. Factual failures and pre-execution seat gates are distinct.

Recorded terminal reason	Sessions / primary base
403 retrieval; client approval review on redirected application	1 / 210
502 Bad Gateway; connection refused	2 / 210
CloudFront 403 request blocked	1 / 210
Site Unavailable; unable to access sales form	1 / 210
application content empty; pricing candidate and browser inaccessible	1 / 210
attempted pricing URL returned 404	1 / 210
browser failed before sales form could be opened	1 / 210
browser inspection and screenshot requests timed out	1 / 210
browser page-reading timed out before form opened	1 / 210
browser repeatedly timed out before demo form loaded	1 / 210
browser timed out before requested form opened	1 / 210
contact form inspection timed out	1 / 210
contact navigation aborted; browser inspection timed out	1 / 210
contact page form render empty; browser inspection timed out	1 / 210
contact-sales page reading and display timed out; form not verified	1 / 210
demo form could not be verified after browser timeouts	1 / 210
demo form fields did not render; subsequent inspection timed out	1 / 210
demo modal heading loaded; form inspection repeatedly timed out	1 / 210
demo navigation and inspection timed out	2 / 210
demo navigation timed out; reached contact page has no sales form	1 / 210
embedded appointment form could not be read after timeouts	1 / 210
initial sales URL 404; contact form navigation repeatedly timed out	1 / 210
live page retrieval nearly empty; answer relied on indexed own-site copies	1 / 210
live pricing returned only iframe and image; indexed prices used	1 / 210
live site content type unsupported; indexed own-site content used	1 / 210

Recorded terminal reason	Sessions / primary base
missing pricing page	1 / 210
missing pricing page (404)	1 / 210
no dedicated demo or sales form appeared; only account-access email field	1 / 210
no embedded demo or sales form on reached contact route	1 / 210
no pricing page or published plan table reached	1 / 210
no public pricing page found; product page only	1 / 210
pricing URL not accessible via the buyer tool; no pricing destination found	1 / 210
pricing URL not accessible via the buyer tool; pricing destination not established	1 / 210
pricing destinations inaccessible; browser error	1 / 210
pricing inaccessible; homepage fetch timeout	1 / 210
pricing inaccessible; unsupported content and browser error	1 / 210
pricing page not accessible; product content only	1 / 210
pricing route describes loan-pricing product; no purchase-pricing page	1 / 210
pricing unavailable; homepage retrieval timed out	1 / 210
regional video demo has no request form; contact navigation timed out	1 / 210
requested pricing page not accessible	1 / 210
sales form could not be inspected; repeated browser timeouts	1 / 210
sales form fields did not appear; subsequent inspection timed out	1 / 210
sales-form navigation and inspection timed out	1 / 210
site unavailable; 403 retrieval	1 / 210

Pipedrive S2 reported EUR 14, 39, 59 and 79 per seat per month with annual billing, totals 168, 468, 708 and 948, VAT extra. The vendor's English page and German locale selected through its visible language control served USD at the same figures on 6 October. Those observations neither verify nor refute the EUR claim. Correct is unknown, the session is unscored, and its repeat pair has no complete-triplet agreement classification.

The Pipedrive S1 and S2 repeats also reported EUR figures. The same unknown-evidence rule is applied to those repeat answers; identical unverified numbers are not proof of factual correctness or verified

agreement. The two affected task pairs are listed as unknown. The primary S1 answer was in USD and was independently verified, so that original score is retained.

Dentrix Ascend S2 claimed its Packages and Suites page named no tiers; the same-day comparison table named Ascend Essentials, Ascend Pro and Ascend Accelerate. AppFolio S1 and S2 broadly claimed no dollar prices were published; the same-day rendered pricing page displayed Core, Plus and Max starting at \$1.49, \$3.20 and \$5.00 per unit monthly. These three of 210 primary sessions are factual failures. A regional or rendering difference alone was not treated as a false fact.

EZLynx S3 had a pre-execution unusual-activity seat event. The owner-requested fresh retry completed and is counted once, with its actual form-render timeout. A Sectra pre-navigation approval-service 429 and other pre-execution fetch failures are separately retained and excluded. No study task was paid for, no challenge was solved, and no vendor form was typed into or submitted. In three form observations, masked phone-field displays could not prove literal emptiness; receipts retain that uncertainty rather than claiming it was visually established.

Repeat agreement

Vendor	Task	Gap after primary end	Triplet agreement
8am MyCase	S1	2.17 hours	yes
8am MyCase	S2	2.28 hours	yes
8am MyCase	S3	2.28 hours	yes
Buildertrend	S1	7.77 hours	yes
Buildertrend	S2	7.65 hours	yes
Buildertrend	S3	7.59 hours	yes
Buildium	S1	2.04 hours	yes
Buildium	S2	2.04 hours	yes
Buildium	S3	2.04 hours	yes
Housecall Pro	S1	3.11 hours	yes
Housecall Pro	S2	3.12 hours	yes
Housecall Pro	S3	3.12 hours	yes
ICE Mortgage Technology	S1	2.08 hours	yes
ICE Mortgage Technology	S2	2.17 hours	yes
ICE Mortgage Technology	S3	2.06 hours	yes
Mews	S1	2.53 hours	yes
Mews	S2	2.53 hours	yes
Mews	S3	2.53 hours	yes
Pipedrive	S1	2.01 hours	unknown
Pipedrive	S2	2.01 hours	unknown
Pipedrive	S3	2.02 hours	yes
SAP Transportation Management	S1	2.01 hours	yes
SAP Transportation Management	S2	2.01 hours	yes
SAP Transportation Management	S3	2.01 hours	yes
Tekion	S1	3.74 hours	yes
Tekion	S2	3.75 hours	yes
Tekion	S3	3.75 hours	no

Vendor	Task	Gap after primary end	Triplet agreement
Wrike	S1	2.01 hours	yes
Wrike	S2	2.01 hours	yes
Wrike	S3	2.01 hours	yes

Across all 30 captured pairs: 27 agree, 1 disagree, and 2 are unknown. Each count uses 30 captured pairs as its base; the planned base is 30.

Complete-triplet agreement is 27 of 28 evaluable pairs (96.4%; 95 percent Wilson interval 82.3% to 99.4%). All 30 of 30 captured pairs are shown, including 2 pairs with an unknown score. Agreement over all 30 pairs cannot be assigned a point value while those comparisons are unknown; no missing comparison is counted as agreement or disagreement.

What the study does not prove

This records one agent product on stated dates with fixed prompts. It is not an agent comparison, a vendor ranking, an endorsement, or a judgment of software quality. It does not measure buyer adoption or promise a shortlist, position, inclusion, lead or revenue. Selection of highly named Index vendors is not random sampling of all software companies. A reached page does not prove an entire site is accessible. Answers, website content, localization, model behavior and tool reliability can change.

The domain-only S2 and S3 prompts can reach another product family. Oracle S2 returned OCI examples, SAP primary S2 returned application-package categories and its repeat reached the S4HANA Cloud ERP pricing section, and IDEXX S2 returned Petly Plans. DaySmart S2 returned four product families, including Vet. Scoring follows the literal submitted prompt. These outcomes do not establish that Oracle Transportation Management, SAP Transportation Management, Cornerstone or Neo prices were found. Prompts and results were not changed after this limitation became visible.

Dispute route

Any tested vendor may request one re-run of its three tasks at no cost by writing to index@broadcastwell.com. Both original and re-run results will be published, with dates and reasons. Original receipts are retained. No vendor is ranked.

Data, dates and reuse

The CSV contains all 210 primary session rows and all 30 repeat rows. Blank Correct values for Pipedrive primary S2 and repeat S1/S2 mean unknown evidence, not zero or no. Receipt and screenshot columns are local evidence paths, not a claim that private conversation files are hosted publicly. The frozen selection and repeat files and the dated protocol amendment accompany the dataset. License: Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International, <https://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>. Attribute Broadcastwell and retain the dates and limitations.

Vendor-set SHA256: a11035069a3cd90fbcff98de56c28cdef82561ec1ec08b633723e044ad041299.

Repeat-set SHA256: 4e4d6ab02ad56a1ff8e2522eb6dad32719f4719a8d1b0a683844cdd9fb0c6e40.

Study DOI: <https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.23197560>

Archive correction: release v1.0.1 preserves the original CSV bytes and both frozen hashes. Git normalized line endings in the first v1.0 archive, while all parsed rows, selections and reported figures were identical. Both dated releases remain available; this report cites the corrected archive.

Method notes

The study's factual rule is unchanged: Correct requires no false vendor fact against the vendor's own page read the same UTC day. A price omission is not automatically a false fact; a broad false claim that no price or tier is published is. Missing source verification remains unknown. Found, Correct and Reached are separately retained, and a reported access failure does not become a factual failure merely because the page worked for the reviewer.

The safety instruction and exact filled task were read back before Send. Fresh conversations were used, visible activity was retained without reconstructing hidden activity, and repeat prompts were checked against primary receipts. Reviewer source retrieval is independent of the measured agent's tool and is labeled as such. No rerun replaced an adverse primary result. Pre-execution operator or seat events are retained outside the vendor-session denominator.

The publisher sells measurement and remediation services in this market. These dated findings are not peer reviewed, do not rank vendors, and are separate from the Index release's named or cited counts. A vendor may use the dispute route regardless of any commercial relationship.